

one shown in [Figure 7.3](#)). I checked each one to be sure it was a proper pattern. I uncovered almost 2,700 patterns in 765 stocks using data from July 1991 to September 2019. Not all stocks covered the entire period, and some no longer trade.

**[Table 7.2](#)** General Statistics

| Description                               | Bull Market  | Bear Market  |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|
| Number found                              | 2,172        | 514          |
| Reversal (R), continuation (C) occurrence | 100% R, 0% C | 100% R, 0% C |
| Average rise                              | 46%          | 30%          |
| Standard & Poor's 500 change              | 13%          | 1%           |
| Days to ultimate high                     | 213          | 83           |
| How many change trend?                    | 62%          | 47%          |

**Reversal (R), continuation (C) occurrence.** The big W is a reversal pattern. Price enters the pattern from the top (going down) and exits out the top (going up), reversing the inbound downtrend by definition.

**Average rise.** The average rise is decent in bull markets, with gains averaging 46%. That's if you trade it perfectly, over 2,000 times. Your trades may do better or worse than what's shown in the table. As you would expect, bear markets with upward breakouts see price climb less far than in bull markets.

**Standard & Poor's 500 change.** I measured performance of the S&P 500 index from the date of the big Ws breakout to the ultimate high. The table shows the result, which is inferior to the big W's performance. I'm not sure if the comparison is fair. It might be like comparing the times of two marathon runners, one who is top ranked and the other who is an amateur. The top-ranked runner will have a better time than one who walks the 26 miles.

**Days to ultimate high.** To gain 46%, it takes time, about 7 months in bull markets. Bear markets see gains taking less time (about 3 months), but that's because the average rise is less, 30%. However, a check of the numbers says the velocity in bear markets is higher than in bull markets, even when a rising price trend is heading against the current in bear